

CAMBRIDGE O LEVEL – ISLAMIYAT 2058/12

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Question 1

I have chosen passages (2) and (3).

(a) Main Themes

Passage (2) – Sura 42:4–5

The main theme of this passage is that everything in the heavens and the earth belongs to Allah. He is the highest and the greatest. The passage also talks about the angels who praise Allah and ask for forgiveness for the people on earth. Another theme is that Allah is forgiving and merciful.

Passage (3) – Sura 112

This Sura is about Tawhid which means the oneness of Allah. It says that Allah is one and only, He is eternal, He was not born and He did not give birth to anyone, and nothing is like Him. This is the most important Sura about who Allah is.

(b) Importance in a Muslim's Life Today

Passage (2) – Sura 42:4–5

This passage is important because it reminds Muslims that Allah is always in control and that everything belongs to Him. So when Muslims are worried or scared they should remember that Allah is the most powerful. It also tells them that the angels pray for human beings which is a comforting idea. Because Allah is merciful, Muslims can ask for forgiveness when they make mistakes and He will forgive them. This encourages Muslims to repent instead of giving up.

Passage (3) – Sura 112

Sura 112 is very important because Muslims recite it every day in salah. The Prophet said it is equal to a third of the Quran so reading it gives a lot of reward. It also protects Muslims from believing wrong things about Allah, like that He has a son or a family. This is important especially in a world where other religions have different ideas about God. It keeps Muslim belief clear and simple.

Question 2

(a) God's Responsibility and Human Duties According to the Qur'an

The Qur'an teaches us that Allah has taken on the responsibility of looking after all His creation. In return, humans have duties towards Him.

In Sura Al-Fatiha, we read that Allah is the Lord and Sustainer of all the worlds. This means He is responsible for providing everything that creation needs. He is also described as the Most Merciful and the Master of the Day of Judgement. So He takes care of us and He will judge us on the Last Day. The duty of humans is to worship Him alone and to walk on the straight path.

Sura 2:21–22 is very direct. It tells humans to worship Allah because He created them. It describes how Allah made the earth comfortable for humans and the sky above them, and how He sends rain so that fruits can grow for them to eat. This is Allah's responsibility – providing everything humans need. In return humans must not associate partners with Allah.

Sura 96 tells us that Allah taught man through the pen – meaning He gave humans the gift of knowledge and learning. Humans should therefore use this knowledge to worship Allah and be grateful, not to become arrogant like the Sura later warns.

Sura 99 teaches that on the Day of Judgement the earth will speak and every person will see their deeds, both good and bad, even if they were tiny. This shows Allah's responsibility is to bring fair justice, and the human duty is to always behave well knowing they will be accountable.

So overall the Qur'an presents the relationship between God and humans as one based on creation, provision, gratitude and accountability.

(b) Should Muslims Protect the Environment?

I agree with this statement. The Qur'an in Sura 2:22 says that Allah created the earth and everything in it for humans. But this means humans should look after it as a trust from Allah, not destroy it. If we damage the environment we are being ungrateful to Allah for everything He has given us. Wasting or destroying nature is a form of ingratitude which is not allowed in Islam.

Question 4

(a) Two Battles: Khaybar and Mu'ta

Battle of Khaybar (7AH / 628 CE)

The Battle of Khaybar was fought in 7 AH against the Jews of Khaybar who had been causing problems for the Muslims and had broken agreements with them. The Prophet (PBUH) led the Muslim army to the oasis of Khaybar, which had several large forts. The Muslims surprised the people of Khaybar early in the morning.

The Prophet gave the banner to Ali ibn Abi Talib (RA) to carry. The Muslims fought hard and managed to take the smaller forts one by one until they reached the strongest fort called An-Nizar or Qamus. Ali (RA) is said to have shown great strength in this battle. The Jews eventually agreed to surrender and asked if they could remain in the oasis and continue farming, in exchange for giving half their produce to the Muslims every year. The Prophet agreed to this.

The Battle of Khaybar was important because it removed a major threat to the Muslims and also showed the growing military power of the Muslim community.

Battle of Mu'ta (8AH / 629 CE)

The Battle of Mu'ta happened because the Prophet (PBUH) had sent a messenger called Al-Harith bin Umair with a letter to the ruler of Busra. However, the governor of al-Balqa, Shurahbil, intercepted and killed him. Killing a messenger was a very serious act and the Prophet decided to send an army of 3000 men to respond.

The Prophet appointed Zayd bin Haritha (RA) as the leader of the army, and said that if he fell, Ja'far bin Abi Talib (RA) should take over, and if he fell, Abdullah bin Rawaha (RA) should take command. When the Muslim army arrived they found that Heraclius, the Byzantine emperor, had gathered a massive army of around 100,000 soldiers plus another 100,000 from allied tribes. This was a huge difference in numbers.

All three appointed leaders were killed in the battle. Then Khalid bin Walid (RA) stepped up and took command. He was a brilliant military strategist. He managed to rearrange the troops and trick the Byzantine army into thinking they were surrounded. The Byzantines stopped chasing the Muslims, which allowed the Muslim army to retreat and return to Madina with minimal casualties. Khalid bin Walid earned the title Sayf Allah (Sword of Allah) after this battle.

(b) Lessons Muslim Leaders Can Learn from the Battle of Mu'ta

I think Muslim leaders today can learn a lot from the Battle of Mu'ta. The most important lesson is about strategic leadership in difficult situations. Khalid bin Walid (RA) was not even the appointed leader but he stepped up when it was needed and saved the army. This shows that a good leader must be flexible and adaptable. Even when outnumbered, a smart strategy can change the result.

Another lesson is about having a plan B. The Prophet (PBUH) wisely appointed backup leaders before the battle even started, knowing that anything could happen. Leaders today should also always have contingency plans and not rely on only one person.

Also, the battle shows that standing up for justice – in this case responding to the murder of a messenger – is important even when it is very difficult and costly. Muslim leaders should not let injustices go unanswered even if the challenge seems overwhelming.

Question 5

(a) Aisha's Life During the Prophet's Lifetime

Aisha bint Abi Bakr (RA) was the daughter of Abu Bakr (RA), who was the Prophet's best friend. She married the Prophet Muhammad (PBUH) and became one of his wives. She was known for being very intelligent and having an excellent memory from a young age.

Because Aisha lived with the Prophet in his house, she had the chance to see and hear everything he did and said. This made her one of the most knowledgeable people about the Prophet's life and practices. She used to ask the Prophet questions about things she didn't understand and he would always answer her patiently.

One of the most important events in her life was the incident of the false accusation (known as the event of Ifk). When the Muslims were returning from a military expedition, Aisha got

separated from the caravan and came back the next day with a companion. People started to spread rumours and say bad things about her. This was a very difficult time for her and the Prophet. After about a month, Allah revealed verses in Sura 24 (An-Nur), declaring that Aisha was completely innocent and condemning those who spread the lies. Those who made false accusations were punished.

Aisha also participated in some of the Prophet's military expeditions. She was present during the Battle of Uhud, where she helped by giving water to the wounded.

When the Prophet passed away, he was in Aisha's room and died with his head in her arms. This shows how much he loved and trusted her.

(b) Is Aisha a Role Model for Muslim Women?

I agree that Aisha (RA) is a role model for Muslim women. She was one of the greatest scholars in Islamic history. She narrated more than 2000 hadiths, which are still used today by scholars to understand the Sunnah of the Prophet. Men and women would come to her from different places just to learn from her.

Aisha also shows that a Muslim woman can be brave and outspoken. She was not shy about asking questions or correcting mistakes. She shows that Islamic tradition values women who are educated and confident.

Some people might argue that she is not a relevant role model for modern women because she lived so long ago and society is very different now. But I think her core qualities of seeking knowledge, being honest, and being dedicated to her faith are timeless and very relevant today.